

BI Advisory Report

Hello Camila of Xebia, thank you for contacting us and filling in our questionnaire.

This personalised report is based on the questionnaire you have just filled in, which was carefully crafted by our team to reflect the most important aspects regarding your BI infrastructure. Our proprietary rules engine assigned scores against your responses to the three major BI tools (PowerBI, Tableau, Looker) based on our years of experience working with these tools. The LLM then translated our logic into a clear, readable format tailored specifically to your situation. Enjoy reading your report!

Your responses highlight an opportunity to strengthen **data governance** and automate pipelines to ensure reliable, timely insights while embedding BI in key workflows. We recommend **Looker** for its robust semantic layer and version control that align with your Analytics Engineers and support scalable, governed analytics, provided cost and change management are addressed from the outset.

Executive Summary

Opportunities and Risks

Opportunities	Risks
Align technology selection with governance processes	Migration without clear governance can create divergence
Leverage Analytics Engineers to build a semantic layer	Lack of automated monitoring may lead to delayed fixes
Automate data pipelines to improve freshness	Unstandardized version control could cause drift
Embed BI in workflows to increase adoption	Cost overruns if licensing and capacity are not planned

Advice: Define a governance framework, architect a unified data environment, automate pipelines, implement access control, and plan change management before selecting a BI tool.

BI Tool Comparison

Category	Power BI	Tableau	Looker
Ecosystem	5	4	3
Security	4	4	5
Data governance	4	4	5
Maturity level	4	3	4
Capabilities	4	4	4
Total	21	19	21

Looker and Power BI tie with 21 points. Looker leads in governance and security while Power BI excels in ecosystem integration and cost efficiency. Tableau offers best-in-class visualisation but trails on governance and scalability.

Detailed Analysis

1. Current Landscape: Where You Stand

Current Set-Up	Assessment
Current BI tool	Tableau
Ecosystem	Intermediate
Data governance and version control	2/5
Maturity level	3/5
Visualisation requirements	Interactive elements occasionally needed
Current challenges	Ad-hoc governance and limited automation

Your current setup demonstrates strong data literacy but lacks robust governance, version control, and automated monitoring to fully support reliable decision-making.

2. Strategic Advice: What This Means for Your Business

Opportunities and Risks Ahead

Your team's advanced data literacy and active migration create a chance to establish a cohesive **data governance** framework that unifies ownership, definitions and policies. Embedding a centralised semantic layer will reduce duplication and improve consistency across reports. Automating pipelines and alerting will support reliable data delivery and free analysts to focus on insights. By aligning BI adoption with decision workflows, you can accelerate time to value and foster a data-driven culture.

On the risk side, proceeding without a clear governance plan may amplify inconsistencies across environments and reports. Limited version control exposes you to diverging report versions and unresolved errors. Without automated monitoring, performance bottlenecks and data issues may go undetected. Cost management and licensing complexity can also hamper scalability if not addressed early. Change management is critical to ensure users embrace new processes and tools.

Future Scenarios: Action vs. Inaction

If you take action now, you will build a resilient, scalable BI environment that supports self-service analytics and governed data access. Defining roles, policies and metadata standards will reduce friction and accelerate deployment of new reports. Architecting a unified data platform and automating ingestion and transformation pipelines will ensure data quality and freshness. Implementing robust access controls and version control workflows will mitigate security and consistency issues. Proactive change management and training will drive adoption and user satisfaction.

Inaction will leave your team managing growing complexity and manual processes. Data inconsistencies and performance issues may erode trust in analytics. Lack of governance can lead to security gaps and compliance risks. As usage grows, cost unpredictability and licensing conflicts may arise. Without clear ownership and training, adoption could stagnate and limit ROI on your BI investment.

3. Exploring BI Options

Now that we've covered what you need to do, let's check some BI tool options and how they fit with your set-up.

BI Tool Comparison

Power BI offers seamless integration with Microsoft tools, a rich connector ecosystem and cost-effective per-user licensing. It delivers generative AI insights and low barriers for Excel users. Drawbacks include licensing complexity, dataset size limits in the Pro tier and dependency on capacity-based deployments for large models.

Tableau excels at visualization with a drag-and-drop interface, advanced mapping and storytelling features. It handles complex data well and benefits from a robust community. Downsides include higher cost, steeper learning curve for advanced analytics and less integrated data preparation capabilities.

Looker stands out with a modern cloud-native architecture, LookML modeling language and strong Git-based version control. It supports a central semantic layer and embedded analytics with reusable components. The main challenges are higher cost, technical barrier due to SQL requirements and cloud-only deployment.

The subsequent table offers a side-by-side comparison of Power BI, Tableau, and Looker, following a set of rules specifically defined by our team:

Category	Power BI	Tableau	Looker
Ecosystem (Fit with your existing tech stack and tools)	5	4	3
Security (Row-level security and compliance capabilities)	4	4	5
Data governance (Centralized governance & version control)	4	4	5
Maturity level (Suitability for your team's skills & processes)	4	3	4
Capabilities (Real-time updates & report delivery)	4	4	4
Total	21	19	21

How We Calculate These Scores

Our scoring system evaluates each BI tool across five key categories, with different maximum point values based on the number and importance of criteria in each category. The scores are generated through a rules-based engine that matches your specific requirements—including your existing technology stack, security needs, team capabilities, governance maturity, and desired features—against predefined criteria.

Each rule in our system is triggered when your situation aligns with specific conditions. For example, using Microsoft Azure adds points to Power BI's ecosystem score, requiring advanced row-level security favors Looker, and having a code-first team benefits Looker's maturity score. When multiple rules match your situation, points accumulate to create a comprehensive evaluation.

The categories weight differently based on scope: **Ecosystem** reflects platform fit; **Security** addresses access controls; **Data governance** evaluates centralized management; **Maturity level** assesses team readiness and approach; and **Capabilities** encompasses features, visualizations, and pain point resolutions.

The scores serve as guidance to help you identify which tool may work best for your organization, rather than absolute facts. Each tool has unique strengths, and the right choice depends on your specific priorities and constraints.

Your team's reliance on Tableau and your migration plans show that you value visual exploration and trust a mature platform. Looker's strengths in modeling, governance and embedded analytics align with your Analytics Engineers and long-term scalability, though budget planning is essential. Power BI may appeal if you prioritise cost efficiency and Microsoft ecosystem integration. Each tool can fit your environment if governance, architecture and change management are put in place first. For a final decision, please contact Xebia for a detailed evaluation of your setup and tailored guidance.

4. How We Can Help You Succeed

Consulting

Understanding your unique challenges and how they can be transformed into growth opportunities, here's how our services can provide a custom solution for your needs.

- **Scalability:** We will design cloud architectures and optimise capacity configurations to handle growing data volumes and user concurrency. This ensures your BI environment can expand seamlessly while keeping performance and costs in balance.
- **Data Quality:** We establish data quality frameworks, implement validation rules, profiling and anomaly detection, and set up monitoring dashboards with alerts. This creates trust in your data and supports confident decision-making.

- **Performance:** We analyse and tune data pipelines, refine data models and optimise queries. Our approach includes setting appropriate storage modes and caching strategies to deliver fast, responsive reports even for complex datasets.
- **Data Governance:** We help define ownership, roles, policies and metadata standards. By implementing centralized semantic layers and audit trails, we ensure consistency, compliance and clarity across your BI landscape.
- **AI Implementation:** We integrate generative AI and agentic AI capabilities to automate insights and build virtual agents for natural language queries. This accelerates analytics and democratizes access to data-driven intelligence.

Academy

Xebia has a dedicated academy offering high-end trainings that address gaps in version control, semantic modeling, data storytelling and pipeline automation. We recommend courses such as [Power BI in a Day](#), [Power BI - Intermediate](#), [Power BI - Advanced](#), [Data Storytelling](#), [Power BI - Exam training](#) and [dbt Learn](#). While our academy focuses on Power BI, we can also deliver tailor-made trainings for Looker, Tableau or other BI tools to meet your team's needs.

5. Cost Analysis

Tableau

Pricing Model: Per-user licensing

Considerations: Higher entry price but scales well for organizations with many view-only users

Annual Estimate for the Enterprise edition for a 50-Person Organization (10 Creators, 15 Explorers, 25 Viewers): **~€36,900/year**

Tableau offers three editions to their users: Tableau (comprehensive software package), Enterprise (advanced software package) and Tableau+ (premium package). For the Tableau and Enterprise edition, the fees are available online. Every deployment requires at least one Creator. For exact pricing and more information on the different editions, we would like to refer you to Tableau's [website](#).

User Type	Viewer	Explorer	Creator
Tableau	€15 user/month	€42 user/month	€75 user/month
Enterprise	€35 user/month	€70 user/month	€115 user/month

Power BI

Pricing Model: Per-user licensing

Considerations: Most cost-effective for small to medium businesses, free version available for basic needs

Annual Estimate for 50-Person Organization with all Pro licenses: **~€7,860/year**

Annual Estimate for 50-Person Organization with mixed licenses (10 PPU, 40 Pro): **~€8.988/year**

Power BI offers four editions to their users: a free account, Power BI Pro, Power BI Premium per User and Power BI Embedded. Power BI Pro includes standard features and is available for €13.10/user/month. The Power BI Premium Per User (PPU) includes more advanced features and is available for €22.50/user/month. To view detailed pricing information and learn more about the various editions available, please visit their [website](#).

Looker

Pricing Model: Platform-based with user components

Considerations: Higher entry point but potentially better value for organizations heavily invested in data culture

Annual Estimate for 50-Person Organization: According to [Explo](#) a team with 50 users (40 Standard, 10 Developers) could be looking at \$100,000+ (**€85,970**) per year

Looker pricing has two main components: platform pricing (the cost to run a Looker instance) and user pricing (the cost for licensing individual users to access the Looker platform). Prices are only available through a sales call, but online sources ([Coefficient](#) and [Luzmo](#)) indicate Looker starts at \$60,000 (**€51,570**) per year. Please consult Looker's [website](#) for accurate cost information and additional details about their different product editions.

6. Your Next Step with Xebia

By partnering with Xebia, we can help you overcome your BI challenges across governance, adoption, and scalability.

Please [contact us here](#) here for more information.

Powered by Xebia's Analytics Engineering team